

How To Get Fired

Consider this a “Do not do” list if you like your job, or a “How to get fired” list if you don’t!

1. For a week, set a mouse (the rodent) free in the office everyday. Wait till just before they call the exterminator, then send in snakes to get the mice.
2. Every time your boss gets up from his desk to go to the loo, dial his extension number. Just before he reaches the phone, hang up. Repeat until he ignores the calls and runs screaming to the loo, or until he loses bladder control.
3. After a particularly spicy lunch in the cafeteria, when a lot of people visit the loo, set off the fire alarm.
4. Hang “out of order” signs on all the lifts when everyone is at lunch. After everyone has huffed and puffed their way up to the 16th floor, take a ride up in one. Note: works best in buildings with over 10 storeys.
5. Write a post-it note that says “I need those confidential files we spoke about the other day by tonight. I hope they’re ready.” Stick it on your boss’ monitor. Watch him/her break out into a sweat. Again, works best in large offices where your boss has many more bosses.
6. Buy three tubes of superglue. Glue everything on your bosses’ desk. If you can get your hands on a rivet gun and a drill machine, transfer his desk and chair from the floor to the roof as well.
7. Get access to your company’s EPABX system. Change the hold music to someone burp-singing a popular song.
8. Go to a lot of questionable sites. Sign up for their “free” content using your boss’ e-mail address.
9. Buy three kilos of sugar. Wait for someone to either be fired or quit. Get out the sugar, pour it all around the cap of every boss’ car’s petrol tank. Make sure to drop enough to make it obvious. You have a good chance that most of the bosses will not realise that you need a key to get into gas tanks, and will call for mechanics and a tow truck to send their cars off for servicing. Investigations will point to the employee who recently quit or was fired.
10. Open out the bolts that hold the toilet seats in place. Stand outside and listen to people walk in, “crash,” and then fumble with it trying to figure out how to fix them all back.

Remember, the office is still the place you go to work, so don’t get carried away

will hide your desktop icons. Next, right click on the Taskbar, select Properties, and check the “Auto-hide the taskbar” box. Click OK to exit. The taskbar and the Desktop icons will be hidden, but it looks like the Desktop is active because of the background. When the victim tries to use the computer, he/she will not be able to click anything or do anything, thinking that the computer is hung.

For ethical reasons, if you do this, make sure that there are no important work files open, and if there are, please save and close them, because even a novice user will instantly press “reboot”!

Change It Up

Most people, including touch-typists and advanced users, can be easily fooled by this one. All it takes is a screwdriver and some care: remove the M and N keys from the keyboard, and interchange their positions. Most people will never figure out that they’re actually correctly typing M, and keep thinking that they’re making typos. To illustrate how confusing this can be, especially for those who haven’t had formal typing training, here’s an anecdote. One colleague was trying to play this trick on another, and popped out the M and N keys all right, but then he confused himself, and put them back into their right positions—he thought he had swapped them, but actually he hadn’t. Then he waited for the screams of anguish, and the cursing of the keyboard—they never came! It was only after about three hours that he came back and had a look at the keys and realised he had “out-pranked” himself!

To befuddle your colleagues even more, you can change the keyboard’s layout altogether! In Windows XP, go to **Control Panel > Regional and Language Options**. Under the Language tab, click Details. You will see a list of keyboard layouts. Click Add, and select United States - Dvorak (the Dvorak keyboard layout is a whole different way of organising keys on the keyboard). Now, change the Default Input Lan-

guage to English (United States) - United States-Dvorak. Apply and watch as your victim screams in frustration as “R” becomes “P”, “J” becomes “H”, and other such traumatising transformations occur.

Not-So-Tech Pranks

Here are some innovative suggestions for non-technology-based humour from friends and colleagues:

If your office has a coffee maker, change the coffee to decaf. Wait a month for their bodies to adjust. Change the coffee to espresso. Sit back and watch people go crazy!

Put tape over the microphone of a desk phone (by opening it up). Watch Mr X have to scream into it to be heard. After a week, remove the microphone tape and put it over the ear-piece instead. He’ll still scream and irritate his clients, but now he won’t be able to hear them complain. Just before he’s about to ask for a new phone, remove the tape!

If everyone in your office has desks with drawers, pull out the drawer. Place a cardboard on top of it, turn it upside down and carefully push the drawer back in. Just before you close it completely, pull the cardboard out carefully. Watch as your co-worker drops all the contents of the drawer on his/her feet!

Stay Focused

Remember, the office is still the place you go to work, so don’t get carried away—or you may end up getting fired, and we wouldn’t want that to happen. Keep it down to one a month, or one every three months, and you should be fine.

There are a million things you can do, and if you stick to non-destructive pranks, you ought to make quite a few friends (or enemies) quite quickly. We’d love to hear about some real things that have happened at your workplace. Write in to readersletters@thinkdigit.com and tell us about them! ■

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